

SOMEBODY SAID SOMETHING.

You liked one line. It turns out to be the most useful thing you've told me — and there is a reason it works that the other four now use too.

5

SCRIPTS
ONE FAMILY

24–
28S

EACH
9:16

0.0S

PRODUCT
IN FRAME

11

FAULTS FROM
THE
LAST REEL,
FIXED

WHY THAT LINE WORKS

“Someone asked me where this is from” is not a hook about jewellery. It is **reported speech** — somebody else said something, and you are about to find out what happened. It praises the product without the brand making a single claim, it opens a story the viewer has to finish, and it puts a **third person** in the room. All five scripts here are built on it.

Shoot Clean room, good window light, tripod — the Riya setup, done properly this time

Wardrobe Western, as per the reference — bare arm, sleeve pushed back, gold against skin

Hero Bold Nocturne Bracelet ₹1,999 · **Second** Charm Box Chain ₹2,149

LET SOMEONE ELSE SAY IT.

Five rejections in, the one line you picked out is the one that does four jobs at once. Here is what it is actually doing, so the other four can do it too.

1 · It is social proof with no claim attached

The brand never says the bracelet looks expensive. **A stranger does.** Nobody argues with a reported compliment the way they argue with an advertised one — and legally it is bulletproof, because no claim has been made about the product at all.

2 · It opens a story the viewer has to close

Someone asked... demands a *what happened next*. That is a real curiosity gap, not a manufactured one like “guess the price”. It buys you the four seconds that decide everything.

3 · It is dialogue, in a room with no set

The effectiveness research is blunt that **dialogue, characters and a sense of place** separate ads that work from ads that don’t — and a clean well-lit room gives you no place at all. Reported speech puts a second person in the frame without a second person on set. **It is how you get right-brain advertising out of a tripod and a wall.**

4 · It is built to be forwarded

DM shares now carry roughly 3–5× the weight of a like for reaching new people; comments have collapsed to about 3%. In India a Reel gets forwarded when it lets the sender say something about a *third person*. Every script here has a third person in it.

WHERE THESE CAME FROM

Four of the five are developed straight out of the hook bank in the original teardown — lines **28** (“four people asked me where this is from, in one day”), **29** (“my mother asked if it was real”), **01** (“I almost didn’t order this”) and **32** (“the one people stop you for”). They were sitting in the bank all along under *objection-first* and *social-proof interception* — the two families the CAC data rates highest on cold traffic. I went looking for clever instead.

What the clean room costs, and how these pay it back

A tidy room in good light is the right call — it is how the last reel was shot and the footage was never the problem. But it removes **place**, which is one of the strongest features an ad can have. These scripts compensate in three ways, and every one of them is free:

- **Reported speech in every opening** — a second voice, without a second person.
- **The product is in frame at 0.0 seconds**, on her wrist, in every script. The last reel took 4.6 seconds to show anything and 8.2 to show jewellery.
- **The specs live inside the lines, not in chips.** On-screen text, hard CTAs and fact stacks measurably lower emotional response. The last reel was wall-to-wall chips.

FIVE, WRITTEN OUT.

Clean room, window light, tripod, Western styling, sleeve pushed back. All ~2.7 words a second. Delivery note for all five: tell it, don't perform it. She is repeating something that happened, to one friend, and she is slightly amused by it.

01 YOUR PICK, BUILT OUT

I REMEMBER

27S · REPORTED SPEECH + WITHHOLDING · THE ONE YOU CHOSE

0.0 *[no voice]* **PICTURE** Mid-motion — she pushes her sleeve back and settles the bracelet on her wrist. **Product on screen in frame one.** Don't start static.

0.6 **"Someone asked me where this is from."** **PICTURE** To camera. Like she's telling one friend, not an audience.

3.4 **"And I told her I couldn't remember."** **PICTURE** Small shrug. Entirely unbothered.

5.8 *[beat — hold it one count longer than feels right]* **PICTURE** She looks straight down the lens. Nothing moves.

6.6 **"I remember."** **PICTURE** Cut on the word to macro: the wrist turning, the paperclip links, the pavé one catching. **This cut is the joke — land it on the word, not after.**

8.2 **"I've just been enjoying being the only one who does."** **PICTURE** Stay in macro. Let the metal do the talking while she says it.

11.6 **"It's the Bold Nocturne. It's from Naira."** **PICTURE** Back to her. First and only time the brand is spoken.

14.4 **"18K gold-plated over surgical steel, anti-tarnish sealed."** **PICTURE** Macro, slow rotate. One soft key, one small hard glint — without the glint gold reads as plastic.

18.0 **"Lobster clasp, little extender, so it fits anyone."** **PICTURE** One-handed clasp click in close-up, with the live sound.

21.2 **"Nineteen ninety-nine. One-fifty to deliver it."** **PICTURE** Worn, whole arm, natural light. Price chip beside the wrist, not in a corner.

24.0 **"Seven-day returns. Go on. Take it."** **PICTURE** Small smile. She gives in. Then 1.3s end card over live footage, music resolving.

Why it works. The whole ad is one small confession — she was gatekeeping, and she's decided to stop. That turns the price reveal into a *surrender* rather than a pitch, which is the most disarming way to say a number out loud. **"I remember" is the best two words in anything I've written for you,** and the cut lands on them. 61 words.

02

SHE ASKED IF IT WAS REAL

26S · REPORTED SPEECH + THE HARDEST POSSIBLE CRITIC

0.0 [no voice] PICTURE Already wearing it. She turns her wrist over, once, looking at it.

0.5 “My mum picked up my wrist at a wedding and said — ‘ye asli hai?’ ” PICTURE To camera. The quoted bit in her mother’s voice, not her own. That switch is the whole performance.

5.0 “Which, from her, is a compliment.” PICTURE Dry. Beat.

7.4 “She has been buying gold for forty years. She was not being polite.” PICTURE Macro on the links, turning slowly.

12.0 “It’s not gold. It’s 18K gold-plated over surgical steel.” PICTURE Stay in macro. Saying it isn’t gold is the strongest thing in this script — own it, don’t hurry past it.

16.0 “Anti-tarnish sealed, nickel-free, two years on the plating.” PICTURE Clasp click with the sound, then worn on the wrist.

20.2 “Nineteen ninety-nine, one-fifty delivered, seven-day returns.” PICTURE Whole arm, natural light, price chip beside the piece.

24.2 “I still haven’t told her.” PICTURE Small smile, straight to camera. End card over live footage.

Why it works. Your mother is the most sceptical jewellery buyer you will ever meet, and if she can’t tell, nobody can. It kills the trust objection with a witness instead of an argument — and because *she* volunteers that it isn’t real gold, the brand never has to defend anything. The last line is the forward: every woman sends this to the friend whose mother is the same. **Highest share potential of the five.**

03

I ALMOST DIDN'T ORDER IT

26S · OBJECTION-FIRST — THE LOWEST-CAC FAMILY ON COLD TRAFFIC

0.0 *[no voice]* PICTURE Wearing it. Sleeve pushed back. She's looking at the camera before she speaks.

0.4 **"I almost didn't order this."** PICTURE Flat. Honest. No smile yet.

2.4 **"Two thousand rupees for something that looks like this felt wrong."** PICTURE Macro: the bracelet, generous, unhurried. Let the viewer agree with her.

7.0 **"Like there had to be a catch."** PICTURE Back to her. Beat.

9.4 **"The catch is that it's plated. It's not solid gold and it never said it was."** PICTURE Straight to camera. Completely level. This is the line the whole ad rests on.

14.8 **"18K over surgical steel, anti-tarnish sealed, two years on the plating."** PICTURE Macro: links, then the clasp closing with the live click.

19.6 **"Nineteen ninety-nine. One-fifty delivered. Seven days to send it back."** PICTURE Worn, whole arm, daylight.

24.0 **"I've worn it every day since."** PICTURE Only if true. If not, use: "I ordered the chain the week after." End card over live footage.

Why it works. Across 52 DTC accounts, objection-first hooks ran **15–25% lower CAC** than benefit-led ones on cold traffic — and at ₹3,000/day you are almost entirely cold. This is the only script of the five that names the catch out loud, which is exactly why it is believed. Run this one at cold audiences.

04

SHE THOUGHT IT WAS A GIFT

24S · REPORTED SPEECH + THE SELF-PURCHASE TURN

0.0 *[no voice]* PICTURE Wearing both pieces. She's adjusting the bracelet as she starts talking.

0.4 "Someone at work said — 'oh, who gave you that?' " PICTURE To camera, reporting it. Light.

3.4 "Nobody gave me that." PICTURE Beat. Flat.

5.2 "I gave me that." PICTURE Cut on the word to macro — the wrist turning. Land the cut on "me".

7.0 "On a Tuesday. For no reason." PICTURE Stay macro. Slow.

9.6 "It's nineteen ninety-nine, which is roughly one dinner out." PICTURE Back to her, wearing it, entirely normal.

13.8 "18K gold-plated over surgical steel. Two years on the plating." PICTURE Clasp click, macro, live sound.

18.0 "One-fifty to deliver, seven days to change your mind." PICTURE Whole arm, daylight.

21.6 "Stop waiting for someone to buy you jewellery." PICTURE Straight to camera. Warm, not preachy. End card over live footage.

Why it works. It sits on a verified shift in how this customer buys — demi-fine is bought as self-celebration, not received as a gift. "I gave me that" is the most forwardable line in the document: it is a small flag planted, and women send that to each other. The cost comparison does the price work without a discount. **Best festive and gifting-season cut.**

05

NOBODY HAS EVER ASKED ME WHAT IT COST

28S · THE INVERSION — KILLS PRICE ANXIETY WITHOUT MENTIONING PRICE

0.0 [no voice] PICTURE Wearing it. Wrist up, turning it in the window light.

0.4 “I’ve worn this to an office, two weddings and a funeral.” PICTURE To camera. Matter-of-fact.
Adjust the list to what is actually true.

4.6 “Not one person has asked me what it cost.” PICTURE Beat.

7.6 “They ask where it’s from. Every single time.” PICTURE Macro: links turning, the pavé catching.

11.0 “That’s the actual thing nobody tells you about jewellery.” PICTURE Back to her.

14.4 “Nobody is doing the maths. They’re just looking.” PICTURE Three fast cuts — same bracelet, three different sleeves. Shoot in ten minutes.

18.0 “18K gold-plated over surgical steel. Anti-tarnish sealed.” PICTURE Macro, clasp click with the live sound.

21.6 “Nineteen ninety-nine. One-fifty delivered. Seven-day returns.” PICTURE Worn, whole arm, daylight. Price chip beside the piece.

25.6 “Nobody’s going to ask. Tap Shop Now.” PICTURE End card over live footage.

Why it works. This is the smartest of the five. The real barrier at this price is not *will it tarnish* — it is **will people be able to tell**. That is a social fear, and social fear is what gets shared. The script answers it by pointing out something true and slightly liberating: nobody is auditing your wrist. It reframes price anxiety out of existence *and* it makes the versatility case. **Highest save potential — this is the one people send to themselves.**

ELEVEN THINGS THE LAST REEL DID.

Same setup as the Riya reel — a tidy room in good light. The footage was never the problem. These are the eleven measured faults that made it a 5.4, and what to do instead. Fixing this list is worth more than the script choice.

LAST REEL DID	DO THIS
01 Opened on a 4.57s static shot; first cut at 4.6s	Motion in frame one , first cut inside 3s. Every script opens on her already moving.
02 No jewellery on screen until 8.2s	Product on the wrist at 0.0s , legible by 3s.
03 Captions sat at y 1396–1512 — inside Instagram's own chrome	Fixed caption band y 1150–1330 . Nothing below y=1420. 68–76px, weight 700–900, white with a 3–5px dark stroke, no box.
04 No music at all; 2.9s of true digital silence at the end	Licensed bed throughout, 85–105 BPM, no vocal, ducked 12–16 dB under the voice. Music resolves under the end card — never cut to silence.
05 No foley on a jewellery ad	Record the clasp click live and lay it on the cut. Ten minutes in a quiet room; best audio you'll get.
06 Hero never shot in macro — the ring was ~40px wide	Tripod, tap to focus then press and hold to lock AE/AF , slide the piece into the focal plane. Phones cannot rack focus.
07 Shot luminance swung 96–201; warmth swung +25 to +80	One white balance for the whole shoot. Match exposure on skin . Target ± 15 luma shot to shot.
08 Ceiling fan in the top third of every talking-head frame	Plain wall . The top third is the only part Instagram doesn't cover — don't spend it on a fan.
09 Two type systems fighting; cards centred in scrim boxes	One caption style. Name and price chips left-aligned, top third . Darken the background region rather than adding a box.
10 Price never appeared on screen once in 33 seconds	Price chip beside the product in frame , carrying + ₹150 insured delivery. Never in a corner.
11 3.3s static flat-colour end card	1.3s, over live footage of the wrist. Small motion on the CTA. Then it loops.

Lighting, since this is the whole reason for a clean room

- **One window, side-on**, subject 1–1.5m from it. White card or a sheet of A4 on the shadow side to lift the fill.
- **For macros, add one small hard glint** — a phone torch bounced off something, or a second window. One soft key alone renders gold as matte plastic; the kicker is what makes it read as metal.
- **Never the built-in flash**. If adding light, CRI ≥ 95 — cheap LEDs put a green spike into gold that no grade removes. And clean the bracelet before every take: at macro a fingerprint is the whole shot.
- **Face on the tripod, macros handheld** with a slight drift — stillness reads as credibility on a face, movement makes metal live. Eyeline on the upper third (y ≈ 640) so the lower frame stays clear for captions.

SOUND — DECIDE BEFORE THE SHOOT, NOT IN THE EDIT

Every currently-trending Indian audio is **unusable in a paid ad**. Instagram listing a sound does not mean Meta licensed it, and a business account can't reach the full library anyway. Use **Meta Sound Collection** (cleared, but Meta platforms only) or **Epidemic / Artlist** if it also has to run elsewhere. Deliver at **-14 LUFS, -1.0 dBTP**. And turn **off** Advantage+ *Music* and *Image animation* at ad level — Meta enables them by default and will lay an unbriefed bed over the voice.

THREE CUTS, ONE AFTERNOON.

THE RECOMMENDATION

Shoot **01**, **03** and **05** in the same session. They share every setup — same room, same light, same wardrobe, same macros. The only thing that changes is what she says to camera. Budget an extra twenty minutes per script, not an extra shoot.

01 “I remember” is the one you already liked and the one to lead with. **03** “I almost didn’t order it” goes to cold traffic, because objection-first is the family with the lowest measured CAC there. **05** “Nobody has ever asked me what it cost” is the one people save, and the one I’d put money on outlasting the other two.

Hold **02** and **04** for the festive window — both are gift-adjacent and both will read better in October than in September.

Shot list — covers all five

SHOT	USED BY
01 To camera, tripod, plain wall, sleeve pushed back, bracelet on — five takes, one per script	all
02 Wrist turning in window light, macro, slow — the money shot	all
03 Lobster clasp closing, macro, live sound	all
04 Pavé link catching the glint, tightest macro on the shoot	01, 02, 05
05 Whole arm worn, daylight, natural — the price beat	all
06 Same bracelet, three different sleeves	05
07 Both pieces worn together, wrist and neck	04
08 Hand adjusting the bracelet, close, no face	opens all five
09 Plain-surface drift for the end card — 4s	all

Nine setups, five talking-head takes. One afternoon, and you leave with three finished ads and the parts for two more.

Then test them properly

Four cells, one body each, everything else held constant, **5–7 days**. Kill on **hook rate under 20% at 5,000 impressions** or **outbound CTR under 0.6% at 8,000** — never before 1,000 impressions or 48 hours. **Use hook rate to kill, never to pick**: no published research links thumbstop to ROAS, and an ad can hold a 45% hook rate and sell nothing. Name them **NAIRA_SEP26_SEJAL_H00K-REMEMBER_27s_9x16_v1** and keep the hook label identical in the ad name, the file name and the UTM.

NON-NEGOTIABLE, ALL FIVE

Never “waterproof” · never “18K gold” — it is 18K gold-plated over surgical steel, and script 02 and 03 say so out loud, which is a strength · any spoken price carries the ₹150 delivery · #Ad in the **top third** from frame one, held a third of the runtime · no named competitor · no false urgency · and **every “someone said” has to be something someone actually said**. The whole family rests on reported speech being real — invent one and the format stops working the moment anyone asks.